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Radiopaque marker and delivery system

Abstract

A radiopaque anchor and delivery device system may comprise a pigtail catheter and a radiopaque anchor. The pigtail catheter may be a dual lumen catheter configured to deploy the radiopaque anchor and delivery a radiopaque fluid or contrast agent. The implantable radiopaque anchor may be slidably disposed within and deployable from a lumen of the elongate shaft. A method for deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor may include advancing a pigtail catheter through the vasculature to a target location; identifying an implant location; forming a channel in a tissue at the implant location; and deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor within the channel.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/117,105 filed on Nov. 23, 2020, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) In general, the present disclosure relates to medical devices and delivery systems. And, more particularly, in certain embodiments, to a method and a system of radiopaque markers for use during an endovascular or cardiac procedure.

BACKGROUND

(2) Transcatheter aortic valve replacement (TAVR) is used to treat aortic stenosis in a growing number of patients. To precisely deploy the TAVR valve, a clinician needs to get coplanar view (fluoroscopic perpendicular angle of deployment), which allows valve deployment in a 90° plane to the native annulus. The current practice is the placement of one, two, or even three pigtail catheters in the non-coronary cusp and/or right coronary cusp to serve as a landmark to guide the valve implant.

(3) Further, some challenges associated with using one or more pigtail catheters to serve as landmarks during TAVR valve deployment include, but are not limited to: a need to ensure the pigtail catheter stays in place (e.g., is pushed against the nadir of the cusp(s)) for proper annulus

plane identification, a need to use contrast injections for a good fluoroscopic view, and/or pigtail catheter placement in cusps can be somewhat obstructive during TAVR deployment.

(4) According to the European Heart Survey on Valvular Heart Disease, 13.3% of patients with isolated, native left-sided valvular heart disease have pure aortic regurgitation (AI) (Iung, et al., Eur Heart J 2003; 24: 1231-1243). Left ventricular assist devices (LVAD) have become an important therapeutic option in patients with and developing end stage heart failure. However, up to 30% of patients with continuous-flow LVAD potentially develop significant AI within 3 years. A transcatheter solution would be highly valuable in above patient population given the high percentage that is inoperable. However, from a technical perspective, performing TAVR procedures in a patient with pure AI is still a challenging approach. There is poor visibility of the aortic valve on fluoroscopy due to a lack of calcium, which is an issue for positioning of the transcatheter valves, and a pigtail in the cusp will lose contrast due to regurgitation into the left ventricle.

(5) The need thus remains for a system which provides for reliable and simple visualization of the aortic artery anatomy.

SUMMARY

(6) The present invention provides a radiopaque marker and delivery system.

(7) In a first example, a radiopaque anchor and delivery device system may comprise a pigtail catheter and an implantable radiopaque anchor. The pigtail catheter may include an elongate shaft extending from a proximal end to a distal end and defining a first lumen and a second lumen. The first lumen may extend distally from a proximal end and may be in fluid communication with one or more apertures extending through a side wall of the elongate shaft. The second lumen may extend distally from a proximal end and may be in fluid communication with at least one opening in the elongate shaft. The radiopaque anchor may be slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft.

(8) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the at least one opening in the elongate shaft may extend through the side wall of the elongate shaft.

(9) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the at least one opening in the elongate shaft may be distally facing.

(10) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the implantable radiopaque anchor may comprise a tubular body extending from a first end to a second end.

(11) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the tubular body may include one or more radially extending barbs positioned adjacent to the second end thereof.

(12) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the one or more radially extending barbs may be configured to anchor the implantable radiopaque anchor within a tissue.

(13) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the implantable radiopaque anchor may comprise a proximal end region and a distal end region.

(14) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the proximal end region may include one or more curved tines and the distal end region includes one or more curved tines.

(15) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the tines may be movable between an expanded deployed configuration and a compressed delivery configuration.

(16) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the proximal end region may comprise a woven structure including one or more filaments.

(17) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the distal end region may comprise an elongate member extending distally from a distal end of the proximal end region.

(18) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the

implantable radiopaque anchor may comprise a helical body.

(19) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the implantable radiopaque marker may comprise a biodegradable polymer doped with or carrying a radiopaque material.

(20) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the implantable radiopaque anchor may be at least partially formed from a shape memory material.

(21) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the system may further comprise a push member slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft.

(22) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the system may further comprise a guidewire slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft.

(23) In another example, a radiopaque anchor and delivery device system may comprise a pigtail catheter and an implantable radiopaque anchor. The pigtail catheter may comprise an elongate shaft extending from a proximal end to a distal end. The elongate shaft may define a first lumen extending distally from a proximal end and in fluid communication with one or more apertures extending through a side wall of the elongate shaft. The elongate shaft may also define a second lumen extending distally from a proximal end and in fluid communication with at least one opening in the elongate shaft. The system may further include a guidewire slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft and a push member slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft and over the guidewire. The implantable radiopaque anchor may be slidably disposed over the guidewire and within the second lumen of the elongate shaft. Distal actuation of the push member may be configured to deploy the implantable radiopaque anchor from the second to lumen.

(24) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the implantable radiopaque anchor may comprise a tubular body extending from a first end to a second end.

(25) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the tubular body may include a first radially extending barb and a second radially extending barb positioned adjacent to the second end thereof.

(26) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the cross-sectional profile of the implantable radiopaque anchor may increase in a distal to proximal direction a long a length of the first and second radially extending barbs.

(27) In another example, a method for deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor may comprise advancing a pigtail catheter through the vasculature to a target location, identifying an implant location, forming a channel in a tissue at the implant location, and deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor within the channel.

(28) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, identifying an implant location may include administering a radiopaque fluid or contrast agent adjacent to the target location.

(29) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor within the channel may comprise distally actuating the implantable radiopaque anchor through a lumen of the pigtail catheter.

(30) In another example, a system for guiding implant depth may comprise a pigtail catheter and an elongate wire. The pigtail catheter may comprise an elongate shaft extending from a proximal end to a distal end and defining a first lumen extending distally from a proximal end and a second lumen extending distally from a proximal end. The first lumen may be in fluid communication with one or more apertures extending through a side wall of the elongate shaft. The second lumen may be in fluid communication with at least one opening in the elongate shaft. The elongate wire may include a plurality of radiopaque markers disposed adjacent a distal end region thereof and be slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft.

- (31) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the at least one opening in the elongate shaft may extend through the side wall of the elongate shaft.
- (32) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the at least one opening in the elongate shaft may be distally facing.
- (33) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the radiopaque markers may be uniformly spaced along the distal end region of the elongate wire.
- (34) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, a distal end of the elongate wire may comprise a needle.
- (35) Alternatively or additionally to any of the examples above, in another example, the system may further comprise a locking mechanism at the proximal end of the elongate shaft. The locking mechanism may be configured to secure the elongate wire relative to the elongate shaft.
- (36) The above summary of exemplary embodiments is not intended to describe each disclosed embodiment or every implementation of the present disclosure.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The invention may be more completely understood in consideration of the following detailed description of various embodiments in connection with the accompanying drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic view of an aortic arch including an illustrative delivery system;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a distal end region of an illustrative pigtail catheter;
- (4) FIG. 3 is an enlarged partial side view of another illustrative pigtail catheter;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of an illustrative implantable radiopaque anchor;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a partial side view of the illustrative radiopaque anchor of FIG. 4 extending from the illustrative pigtail catheter of FIG. 3;
- (7) FIGS. 6A-6C illustrate an illustrative radiopaque anchor in sequential stages of delivery;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a side view of another illustrative radiopaque anchor;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a partial cross-sectional view of the illustrative radiopaque anchor of FIG. 7 disposed within a delivery tube;
- (10) FIGS. 9-15 are perspective views of other illustrative radiopaque anchors;
- (11) FIGS. 16-17 are perspective views of alternative structures for portions of radiopaque anchors;
- (12) FIG. 18 is a perspective view of another illustrative radiopaque anchor;
- (13) FIG. 19 is a perspective view of an illustrative system for measuring a guiding an implant depth;
- (14) FIG. 20 is a schematic view of the illustrative system of FIG. 19 in situ; and
- (15) FIG. 21 is a side view of another illustrative pigtail catheter.
- (16) While the invention is amenable to various modifications and alternative forms, specifics thereof have been shown by way of example in the drawings and will be described in detail. It should be understood, however, that the intention is not to limit aspects of the invention to the particular embodiments described. On the contrary, the intention is to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the spirit and scope of the invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (17) For the following defined terms, these definitions shall be applied, unless a different definition is given in the claims or elsewhere in this specification.
- (18) All numeric values are herein assumed to be modified by the term “about”, whether or not explicitly indicated. The term “about” generally refers to a range of numbers that one of skill in the art would consider equivalent to the recited value (i.e., having the same function or result). In many instances, the term “about” may be indicative as including numbers that are rounded to the nearest significant figure.

(19) The recitation of numerical ranges by endpoints includes all numbers within that range (e.g., 1 to 5 includes 1, 1.5, 2, 2.75, 3, 3.80, 4, and 5).

(20) Although some suitable dimension ranges and/or values pertaining to various components, features and/or specifications are disclosed, one of skill in the art, incited by the present disclosure, would understand desired dimensions, ranges and/or values may deviate from those expressly disclosed.

(21) As used in this specification and the appended claims, the singular forms “a”, “an”, and “the” include plural referents unless the content clearly dictates otherwise. As used in this specification and the appended claims, the term “or” is generally employed in its sense including “and/or” unless the content clearly dictates otherwise.

(22) The following detailed description should be read with reference to the drawings in which similar elements in different drawings are numbered the same. The detailed description and the drawings, which are not necessarily to scale, depict illustrative embodiments and are not intended to limit the scope of the invention. The illustrative embodiments depicted are intended only as exemplary. Selected features of any illustrative embodiment may be incorporated into an additional embodiment unless clearly stated to the contrary.

(23) Transcatheter aortic valve replacement (TAVR) is used to treat aortic stenosis in a growing number of patients. To precisely deploy the TAVR valve, a clinician needs to have a coplanar view (fluoroscopic perpendicular angle of deployment), which allows valve deployment in a 90° plane to the native annulus (formed by hinge points or nadir of the valve cusps). Precise deployment of the valve is important because if the valve is deployed too low the valve may leak and if the valve is deployed too high the valve may damage the coronary arteries. Further, the depth of the implant may be correlated with the likelihood of a permanent pacemaker implant post-TAVR. However, identification of the native annulus may be difficult due to the soft tissue. The current practice includes the placement of one, two, or even three pigtail catheters in the non-coronary cusp and/or right coronary cusp to serve as a landmark to guide the valve implant. However, some challenges associated with using one or more pigtail catheters to serve as landmarks during TAVR valve deployment include, but are not limited to, a need to ensure the pigtail catheter stays in place for proper annulus plane identification (e.g., pushed against the nadir (e.g., attachment points) of the cusp(s)), a need to use contrast injections for a good fluoroscopic view, and/or pigtail catheter placement in cusps can be somewhat obstructive during TAVR deployment (e.g., obstructs the delivery of the TAVR valve). While the disclosure is described with respect to TAVR procedures, it should be understood that the devices and methods described herein are not only to TAVR procedures. The devices and methods described herein can be used in any other procedure where visualization is desired.

(24) The disclosure generally relates to devices and methods for visualization of the aortic anatomy (and/or other anatomy as applicable) as well as devices and method for better controlling implant depth. In some cases, radiopaque markers can be delivered before and/or during an endovascular procedure (e.g., transcatheter aortic valve implantation (TAVI) or replacement (TAVR), transcatheter mitral valve implantation (TAMI) or replacement (TAMR), surgical aortic valve replacement (SAVR), thoracic endovascular aortic repair (TEVAR), other surgical valve repair, implantation, or replacement, to facilitate precise deployment or repair of a valve or other anatomy. In yet other cases, radiopaque markers can be delivered before and/or during procedures in other parts of the body.

(25) FIG. 1 is a schematic view of an aortic arch **10** including a delivery system **100** for delivering an implantable radiopaque marker and/or a replacement valve. The aortic arch **10** is downstream of the aortic valve **11**. The aortic arch **10** typically includes three great branch arteries: the brachiocephalic artery or innominate artery **12**, the left common carotid artery **14**, and the left subclavian artery **16**. The innominate artery **12** branches to the right carotid artery **18**, then the right vertebral artery **20**, and thereafter is the right subclavian artery **22**. The right subclavian artery **22**

supplies blood to and may be directly accessed from the right arm (termed right radial access). The left subclavian artery **16** branches to the left vertebral artery **24**, usually in the shoulder area. The left subclavian artery **16** supplies blood to and may be directly accessed from the left arm (termed left radial access).

(26) The delivery system **100** may include an outer sheath **102** and a pigtail catheter **104**. The outer sheath **102** includes a proximal end (not explicitly shown) and a distal end **106**. The proximal end is configured to be held and manipulated by a user such as a surgeon. In some cases, the proximal end may be coupled to a handle configured to facilitate delivery and deployment of the outer sheath **102**. The outer sheath **102** may define a lumen **108** extending from the proximal end to the distal end **106** thereof. The lumen **108** may be configured to slidably receive the pigtail or angiography catheter **104**, a filter device (for protecting the cerebral vasculature), and/or a procedural catheter (such as, but not limited to a TAVR or TAVI procedural catheter or device), etc. The pigtail catheter **104** may be radially inward of the outer sheath **102** which may have a diameter large enough for a procedural catheter to pass therethrough. The outer sheath **102** may comprise an atraumatic distal tip. In some cases, the outer sheath **102** may be flexible and/or atraumatic. The outer sheath **102** may comprise a curvature, for example based on an intended placement location (e.g., the left subclavian artery **16** and/or the aortic arch **10**). Alternatively, or additionally, the outer sheath **102** may be steerable.

(27) The right femoral artery may be accessed using an introducer. The outer sheath **102** is steered, into or towards the aortic arch **10**. In some cases, the outer sheath **102** may be advanced over a guidewire, although this is not required. In some implementations, the guidewire and the outer sheath **102**, pigtail catheter **104**, and/or other devices may be tracked together, with the guidewire leading the outer sheath **102** (e.g., advance the guidewire a distance, then advance the outer sheath **102** over the guidewire approximately the same distance). In some cases, where the guidewire is floppy or lacks rigidity, it may be introduced inside the outer sheath **102** and then advanced ahead of other devices in the vasculature.

(28) The outer sheath **102** may be advanced into the descending portion of the aortic arch **10**. The pigtail catheter **104** is then advanced through the outer sheath **102** (if it was not advanced with the outer sheath **102**). In some embodiments, the pigtail catheter **104** may be advanced into the ascending portion of the aortic arch **10** where it may deliver a radiopaque fluid or contrast fluid to facilitate visualization of the procedure. In other embodiments, the pigtail catheter **104** may be positioned at or against the cusps or leaflets of the aortic valve **11**. Alternatively, or additionally, the pigtail catheter **104** is used to deliver an implantable radiopaque marker, as will be described in more detail herein. A distal end region **110** of pigtail catheter **104** may have a generally arcuate shape (although this is not required) and include one or more apertures **112a**, **112b**, **112c**, **112d** (collectively, **112**) therein. The one or more apertures **112** may be in fluid communication with a lumen of the pigtail catheter **104** and may be configured to deliver the radiopaque fluid or contrast fluid. Tracking of the delivery system **100** may be performed under fluoroscopy, for example using radiopaque markers (e.g., at a distal end of the outer sheath **102**) and/or radiopaque fluid or contrast media. Radiopaque fluid or contrast media may be provided through the pigtail catheter **104** and/or the outer sheath **102**.

(29) FIG. 2 is an enlarged perspective view of the distal end region **110** of the illustrative pigtail catheter **104**. The pigtail catheter **104** includes a tubular elongate shaft **114** extending from a proximal end configured to remain outside the body to the distal end region **110**. The elongate shaft **114** includes at least one lumen **116** extending from the proximal end thereof to the distal end region **110**. In some cases, the lumen **116** may terminate proximal to the distal end **118** of the elongate shaft **114** while in other cases, the lumen **116** may extend to the distal end **118** to define a distal opening (not explicitly shown). In some embodiments, the elongate shaft **114** may include more than one lumen **116**. When so provided, the two or more lumens may be arranged in a side by side or collinear arrangement, in a coaxial or tube within a tube arrangement, or combinations

thereof. It is further contemplated that when so provided, the two or more lumens may be fluidly isolated from one another.

(30) In the absence of an external biasing force, or in a deployed configuration, the distal end region **110** is configured to assume a curved pigtail or J shape. It is contemplated that the distal end region **110** may have any degree of curvature desired including less than 360° or greater than 360°, as desired. The distal end region **110** may be biased into a generally linear, or delivery, configuration by, for example, a guidewire or stiffening member slidably disposed within the lumen **116** or a stiffer tube (such as, but not limited to, an outer sheath **102**) disposed over an outer surface of the pigtail catheter **104**. These are just examples and are not intended to limit the pigtail catheter **104** to a particular configuration.

(31) The pigtail catheter **104** includes a first set of holes or apertures **112** and a second set of holes or apertures **120a**, **120b** (collectively, **120**). The first set of apertures **112** may include one, two, three, four, or more apertures, as desired. Similarly, the second set of apertures **120** may include one, two, three, four, or more apertures, as desired. The first set of apertures **112** may be in fluid communication with a radiopaque fluid source and/or a contrast fluid source. The second set of apertures **120** may be configured to deploy an implantable radiopaque marker from the lumen **116** of the pigtail catheter **104** and into the body of a patient. For example, the implantable radiopaque markers may be pushed out of at least one aperture **120a**, **120b** and into the nadir of a cusp of the aortic valve using a stiff guidewire, or other pushing element, as will be described in more detail herein.

(32) In some cases, the first set of apertures **112** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **114** such that when the distal end region **110** of the pigtail catheter **104** is in the deployed configuration, the first set of apertures **112** are positioned or directed radially inwards relative to the curve of the distal end region **110** (or on the concave surface thereof). However, this is not required. In some cases, the first set of apertures **112** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **114** such that when the distal end region **110** of the pigtail catheter **104** is in the deployed configuration the first set of apertures **112** are positioned or directed radially outwards (not explicitly shown) relative to the curve of the distal end region **110** (or on the convex surface thereof). It is contemplated that the position of the first set of apertures **112** is not limited to the radially inward or outward surface of the distal end region **110**. It is contemplated that the first set of apertures **112** may be positioned at any circumferential location about the elongate shaft **114**, or combinations of circumferential locations, as desired.

(33) In some cases, the second set of apertures **120** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **114** such that when the distal end region **110** of the pigtail catheter **104** is in the deployed configuration, the second set of apertures **120** are positioned or directed radially outwards relative to the curve of the distal end region **110** (or on the convex surface thereof). However, this is not required. In some cases, the second set of apertures **120** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **114** such that when the distal end region **110** of the pigtail catheter **104** is in the deployed configuration the second set of apertures **120** are positioned or directed radially inwards (not explicitly shown) relative to the curve of the distal end region **110** (or on the concave surface thereof). It is contemplated that the position of the second set of apertures **120** is not limited to the radially inward or outward surface of the distal end region **110**. It is contemplated that the second set of apertures **120** may be positioned at any circumferential location about the elongate shaft **114**, or combinations of circumferential locations, as desired.

(34) FIG. 3 is an enlarged partial side view of another illustrative pigtail catheter **204**. The pigtail catheter **204** includes a tubular elongate shaft **214** extending from a proximal end configured to remain outside the body to the distal end region **210**. The elongate shaft **214** includes at least a first lumen **216** configured to deliver a radiopaque fluid and/or a contrast fluid and a second lumen **226** configured to deliver an implantable radiopaque marker. The two or more lumens **216**, **226** may be arranged in a side by side or collinear arrangement, in a coaxial or tube within a tube arrangement,

or combinations thereof. The two or more lumens **216**, **226** may be fluidly isolated from another (35) The elongate shaft **214** may include a first portion **222** defining the first lumen **216** and a second portion **224** defining the second lumen **226**. It is contemplated that the first and second portions **222**, **224** need not have the same length as each other. In some embodiments, the elongate shaft **214** may be extruded as a single monolithic structure to form side-by-side lumens **216**, **226**. In other embodiments, the elongate shaft **214** may be formed by other suitable means, such as a first and a second separate extruded tubes arranged side-by-side and connected by adhesive, or the like.

(36) The first lumen **216** may extend from the proximal end of the first portion **222** towards a distal end **218** thereof. In some cases, the first lumen **216** may terminate proximal to the distal end **218** of the first portion **222** while in other cases, the first lumen **216** may extend to the distal end **218** to define a distal opening (not explicitly shown). The second lumen **226** may extend from the proximal end of the second portion **224** towards a distal end **228** thereof. The second lumen **226** may extend to the distal end **228** to define a distal opening **220** (e.g., distally facing). However, this is not required. In some cases, the second lumen **226** may terminate proximal to the distal end **228**. In such an instance, a side port may be provided to allow an implantable radiopaque marker to be advanced through and exit the second lumen **226**.

(37) In the absence of an external biasing force, or in a deployed configuration, the distal end region **210** is configured to assume a curved pigtail or J shape. It is contemplated that the distal end region **210** may have any degree of curvature desired including less than 360° or greater than 360°, as desired. The distal end region **210** may be biased into a generally linear or delivery configuration by for example, a guidewire or stiffening member slidably disposed within the lumen **216** or a stiffer tube (such as, but not limited to an outer sheath) disposed over an outer surface of the pigtail catheter **204**. These are just examples and are not intended to limit the pigtail catheter **204** to a particular configuration.

(38) The first portion **222** includes a set of holes or apertures **212a**, **212b**, **212c**, **212d** (collectively, **212**). The set of apertures **212** may include one, two, three, four, or more apertures, as desired. The set of apertures **212** may be in fluid communication with a radiopaque fluid source and/or a contrast fluid source. As described herein, the second portion **224** may include a distal opening **220** through which an implantable radiopaque marker is deployable. For example, the implantable radiopaque markers may be pushed out of the distal opening **220** and into the nadir of a cusp of the aortic valve using a stiff guidewire, or other pushing element, as will be described in more detail herein.

(39) In some cases, the set of apertures **212** may be positioned on the first portion **222** such that when the distal end region **210** of the pigtail catheter **204** is in the deployed configuration, the set of apertures **212** are positioned or directed radially inwards relative to the curve of the distal end region **210** (or on the concave surface thereof). However, this is not required. In some cases, the first set of apertures **212** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **214** such that when the distal end region **210** of the pigtail catheter **204** is in the deployed configuration the first set of apertures **212** are positioned or directed radially outwards (not explicitly shown) relative to the curve of the distal end region **210** (or on the convex surface thereof). It is contemplated that the position of the set of apertures **212** is not limited to the radially inward or outward surface of the distal end region **210**. It is contemplated that the set of apertures **212** may be positioned at any circumferential location about the portion **222**, or combinations of circumferential locations, as desired.

(40) FIG. 4 is a perspective view of an illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **300**. The radiopaque anchor **300** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **300** may have a width **302** and/or depth **304** in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75

mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may have a width **302** and/or depth **304** of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **300** may have a height **306** in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 3.0 mm, about 1.0 mm to about 2.5 mm, or about 1.5 to about 2.0 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may have a height **306** of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 3.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **300** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(41) The radiopaque anchor **300** has a generally tubular body **308** extending from a first or proximal end **310** to a second or distal end **312**. The radiopaque anchor **300** may be formed entirely from a radiopaque material, such as, but not limited to, tantalum or platinum iridium. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be formed from a non-radiopaque material and may be coated with, doped with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **300** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(42) The body **308** may have a generally circular cross-sectional shape, although other shapes may be used as desired. A lumen **314** may extend from the proximal end **310** to the distal end **312**. The lumen **314** may be sized and shaped such that the radiopaque anchor **300** may be advanced over a guidewire or other lead wire (not explicitly shown). The radiopaque anchor **300** further includes one or more radially extending barbs **316a**, **316b** (collectively, **316**). The barbs **306** may be generally uniformly positioned or equally spaced about the circumference of the body **308**, although this is not required. In some cases, the barbs **306** may be eccentrically spaced. The radiopaque anchor **300** may include fewer than two or more than two barbs **316**, as desired. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may include a single barb **316** that extends about an entirety or less than an entirety of the circumference of the body **308**. The barbs **316a**, **316b** each include a proximal end **318a**, **318b** (collectively, **318**) radially spaced from the body **308** and a distal end **320a**, **320b** (collectively, **320**) in contact with the body **308**. For example, over a length of the barbs **316**, the overall cross-sectional dimension increases in the distal to proximal direction. In some embodiments, the barbs **316** may be formed as a single monolithic structure with the body **308**. In other embodiments, the barbs **316** may be formed as separate structures from the body **308** and subsequently attached, coupled or otherwise affixed thereto.

(43) In some cases, the proximal ends **318** of the barbs **316** may be configured to deflect radially inwards to facilitate distal advancement of the radiopaque anchor **300** through a delivery device (such as, but not limited to a pigtail catheter such as those described herein), although this is not required. The distal end **312** of the radiopaque anchor **300** is configured to lead the radiopaque anchor **300** as it is advanced through the delivery device into the bodily tissue. The barbs **316** are angled or sloped such that the radiopaque anchor **300** is easily distally advanced through the tissue but proximal retraction of the radiopaque anchor **300** is difficult or precluded. This may help ensure that once the radiopaque anchor **300** is implanted into the tissue it is self-anchoring. The angle and/or length of the barbs **316** may be varied. It is contemplated that the barbs **316** may have structures or shapes different from an angled surface, including, but not limited to, curves, steps, etc. It is contemplated that other structural features in place of or in addition to the barbs **316** may be used to help secure the radiopaque anchor **300** within the tissue.

(44) FIG. 5 is a partial side view of the illustrative radiopaque anchor **300** extending from an illustrative pigtail catheter **204**. While the radiopaque anchor **300** is shown and described with an illustrative pigtail catheter **204**, it should be understood that the radiopaque anchor **300** may be delivered using other pigtail catheters, such as, but not limited to, the pigtail catheter **104** described herein, or other delivery devices or systems, as desired.

(45) The radiopaque anchor **300** is loaded into the second lumen **226** of the pigtail catheter **204** via

a proximal opening (not explicitly shown). In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be loaded over or slidably disposed over a guidewire **340** received within the second lumen **226**. In some cases, the guidewire **340** may be advanced into the second lumen **226** prior to loading the radiopaque anchor **300** onto the guidewire **340**. In other cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be loaded onto the guidewire **340** prior to advancing the guidewire **340** and the radiopaque anchor **300** into the lumen **226** of the pigtail catheter **204**. Once the radiopaque anchor **300** is disposed within a proximal portion of the second lumen **226**, a delivery tube or push member **342** contacts the distal end **310** of the radiopaque anchor **300** and pushes or distally advances the radiopaque anchor **300** through the second lumen **226** over the guidewire **340** towards the distal opening **220**. In some cases, the guidewire **340** and the push member **342** may be advanced concurrently or in succession (e.g., with the guidewire **340** leading the push member **342**), as desired. It is contemplated that the radiopaque anchor **300**, guidewire **340** and/or push member **342** may be at least partially advanced through the second lumen **226** prior to advancing the pigtail catheter **204** within the vasculature. In other instances, the radiopaque anchor **300**, guidewire **340** and/or push member **342** may be advanced through the second lumen **226** after the pigtail catheter **204** has been advanced through the vasculature and is positioned at or near a target location within the body.

(46) To deploy the radiopaque anchor **300** within the body, the pigtail catheter **204** may be advanced through an outer sheath introduced into the right femoral artery, although other access points may be used as desired. The pigtail catheter **204** may be advanced through the outer sheath to the desired treatment location. In the case of a TAVR procedure, the pigtail catheter **204** may be advanced into the ascending aorta or adjacent to the aortic valve. Once the pigtail catheter **204** is in position a radiopaque fluid and/or contrast agent may be delivered to the anatomy adjacent to the distal end region **210** through the first lumen **216** and the set of apertures **212**. The radiopaque fluid and/or contrast agent may be used to identify the cusps of valve and one or more implant locations for one or more radiopaque anchors **300**. The pigtail catheter **204** may then be oriented such that the distal opening **220** of the second lumen **226** is aligned with the desired implant location.

(47) Referring now to FIGS. **6A-6C**, which illustrate the radiopaque anchor **300** in sequential stages of delivery, once the pigtail catheter **204** is in position the radiopaque anchor **300** is distally advanced from the distal opening **220**. In FIGS. **6A-6C**, the pigtail catheter **204** is not shown to more particularly illustrate the relationship between the radiopaque anchor **300**, the guidewire **340**, and the push member **342**. However, it should be understood that the radiopaque anchor **300** is distally advanced from a lumen of a delivery device, although other delivery methods may be used. Once the pigtail catheter **204** is in position, the guidewire **340** may be distally advanced, as shown at arrow **354** so that it penetrates the target tissue **350** (e.g., the left coronary cusp, right coronary cusp, and/or non-coronary cusp in the case of TAVR). In some cases, the guidewire **340** may include radiopaque markers (not explicitly shown) or include radiopaque material to allow the implant location of the radiopaque anchor **300** to be verified prior to embedding the radiopaque anchor **300** in tissue. Alternatively, or additionally, the distal end **312** of the radiopaque anchor **300** may be brought into contact (e.g., through distal actuation of the push member **342**) with the surface **352** to the tissue **350** to verify the implant location is correct or accurate. The push member **342** may then be used to distally advance the radiopaque anchor **300** over the guidewire **340** and into the tissue **350**, as shown in FIG. **6B**. The angle of the barbs **316** facilitates distal movement of the radiopaque anchor **300** into the tissue **350** and precludes or limits dislodgement (e.g., proximal movement) of the radiopaque anchor **300**.

(48) Once the radiopaque anchor **300** is anchored within the tissue **350**, the guidewire **340**, push member **342**, and pigtail catheter **204** can be proximally retracted, as shown in FIG. **6C**. In some cases, the guidewire **340**, push member **342**, and/or pigtail catheter **204** may be fully removed from body. In other cases, the guidewire **340**, push member **342**, and/or pigtail catheter **204** may be proximally retracted but remain in the body (e.g., displaced from the area of valve implantation). In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be implanted within the tissue **350** such that the

proximal end **310** thereof is fully within the tissue **350** (not explicitly shown). In other embodiments, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be implanted within the tissue **350** such that the proximal end **310** thereof is flush with or about at the surface **352** of the tissue **350**. In yet other embodiments, the radiopaque anchor **300** may be implanted within the tissue **350** such that the proximal end **310** thereof extends from the surface **352** of the tissue **350** (not explicitly shown). Once the radiopaque anchor **300** has been delivered, the pigtail catheter **204** may be used to deliver one or more additional radiopaque anchors **300** to one or more additionally locations. For example, one or more radiopaque anchors **300** may be delivered to each cusp to improve visualization of the anatomy under fluoroscopy. In other cases, a radiopaque anchor **300** may be positioned in each cusp. It is further contemplated that more than one dual lumen pigtail catheter may be used to deploy radiopaque anchors **300** in each cusp simultaneously or substantially simultaneously.

(49) It is contemplated that the implantation of one or more radiopaque anchors **300** may reduce contrast injections within the patient. For example, once the radiopaque anchors **300** are positioned, the radiopaque anchors **300** are able to provide beacons for positioning of the TAVR valve. Further, as the pigtail catheter is not necessary for contrast injections after implantation of the radiopaque anchors **300**, the pigtail catheter (or other delivery system) can be removed from the anatomy which may help facilitate delivery of the TAVR valve (e.g., fewer devices are in the vasculature during delivery of the TAVR valve). Additionally, the radiopaque anchors **300** may enable better visualization of the annulus plane during implantation of the valve while clearly identifying the orientation of the radiopaque anchor **300** relative to the annular plane of the valve.

(50) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of an illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **400**. The radiopaque anchor **400** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **400** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **400** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **400** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **400** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(51) The radiopaque anchor **400** has a proximal end region **402**, a distal end region **404**, and an intermediate region **410** extending between the proximal end region **402** and the distal end region **404**. The radiopaque anchor **400** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol. The radiopaque anchor **400** may be coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **400** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired. The proximal end region **402** includes one or more hooks or tines **406a**, **406b** (collectively, **406**). Similarly, the distal end region **404** includes one or more hooks or tines **408a**, **408b** (collectively, **408**). The radiopaque anchor **400** may be formed such that the tines **406**, **408** extend radially outward from the intermediate region **406** when the radiopaque anchor **400** is in the “remembered” or preformed shape. A biasing force (such as a deployment tube) may bias the tines **406**, **408** such that they extend generally parallel to a longitudinal axis of the intermediate region **410**. Once the biasing force is removed the tines **406**, **408** return to their curved talon-like shape.

(52) FIG. 8 illustrates a partial cross-sectional view of the illustrative radiopaque anchor **400** disposed within a delivery tube **412**. It is contemplated that the delivery tube **412** may be a part of a pigtail catheter, a part of another delivery device, or a separate tubular component disposed within the lumen of a pigtail catheter or other delivery device. The tines **406**, **408** of the radiopaque anchor

400 are deflected such that they extend generally parallel to the longitudinal axis of the intermediate region **410**. This may both reduce the overall profile of the radiopaque anchor **400** for delivery and facilitate deployment into the tissue. A delivery tube or push member (not explicitly shown) may be slidably disposed within the lumen **414** of the delivery tube **412**. The delivery tube **412** may be delivered to the desired treatment location using an outer sheath and radiopaque fluid and/or contrast agent in a similar manner to that described herein. Once the distal end **416** of the delivery tube **412** is adjacent to the target location, a push member may be used to exert a distal force on the proximal ends **416a**, **416b** (collectively, **416**) of the proximal tines **406**. The distal ends **418a**, **418b** (collectively, **418**) of the distal tines **408** may be pointed or sharp to puncture or penetrate the tissue as it is deployed. As the radiopaque anchor **400** is deployed, the tines **406**, **408** resume their curved (or remembered) shape. The curved shape of the tines **406**, **408** in the deployed configuration (e.g., FIG. 7) captures or grips the tissue to ensure the radiopaque anchor **400** does not dislodge from the tissue.

(53) FIG. 9 is a side view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **450**. The radiopaque anchor **450** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **450** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **450** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **450** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **450** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(54) The radiopaque anchor **450** extends from a proximal end **452** to a distal end **454**. The proximal end region **456**, adjacent to the proximal end **452**, may have a flattened spheroid shape. However, other shapes may be used as desired. In some cases, the flattened spheroid shape (or other enlarged shape) may be omitted such that the radiopaque anchor **450** has a generally uniform shape from the proximal end **452** to the distal end **454** thereof. The proximal end region **456** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **450** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **450** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **450**. A cylindrical elongate member **458** may extend distally from the distal end **460** of the proximal end region **456** to the distal end **454** of the radiopaque anchor **450**. In some cases, the elongate member **458** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **458** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown). In some embodiments, the distal end **454** of the radiopaque anchor **450** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **450** into the tissue.

(55) The radiopaque anchor **450** may be formed from a biodegradable or bioabsorbable polymer such as, but not limited to, polylactic acid (PLA), polyglycolic acid (PGA), polycaprolactone (PCL), polycarbonate, polydioxanone (PDO), trimethylene carbonate (TMC), and/or copolymers made from these monomers. The radiopaque anchor **450** may be made radiopaque by including doping, coating the biodegradable polymer with, or otherwise including, with radiopaque materials, shown schematically at **462**, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). It is further contemplated that the radiopaque particles may be disposed within a cavity of the radiopaque anchor **450**, such as, but not limited, within the elongate member **458**. These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **450** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(56) FIG. 10 is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **500**. The radiopaque anchor **500** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **500** may be used in other

anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **500** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **500** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **500** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(57) The radiopaque anchor **500** extends from a proximal end **502** to a distal end **504**. The proximal end region **506**, adjacent to the proximal end **502**, may have a flared cylindrical shape. For example, a first end region **508** and a second end region **510** may have a larger radial dimension than an intermediate region **509**. However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **506** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **512**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **506** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **514**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **506** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **514**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **506** may be laser cut to define the openings **514**. At least the proximal end region **506** of the radiopaque anchor **500** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **506** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **506** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **506** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(58) The proximal end region **506** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **500** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **500** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **500**. A cylindrical elongate member **516** may extend distally from the distal end **518** of the proximal end region **506** to the distal end **504** of the radiopaque anchor **500**. In some cases, the elongate member **516** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **516** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filled with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **504** of the radiopaque anchor **500** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **500** into the tissue.

(59) The radiopaque anchor **500**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **500** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(60) FIG. **11** is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **550**. The radiopaque anchor **550** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **550** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **550** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **550** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **550** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(61) The radiopaque anchor **550** extends from a proximal end **552** to a distal end **554**. The proximal end region **556**, adjacent to the proximal end **552**, may have a flared cylindrical shape. For example, a first end region **558** may have a larger radial dimension than a second end region **560**.

However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **556** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **562**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **556** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **564**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **556** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **564**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **556** may be laser cut to define the openings **564**. At least the proximal end region **556** of the radiopaque anchor **550** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **556** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **556** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **556** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(62) The proximal end region **556** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **550** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **550** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **550**. A cylindrical elongate member **566** may extend distally from the distal end **568** of the proximal end region **556** to the distal end **554** of the radiopaque anchor **550**. In some cases, the elongate member **566** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **566** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filed with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **554** of the radiopaque anchor **550** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **550** into the tissue.

(63) The radiopaque anchor **550**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **550** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(64) FIG. **12** is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **600**. The radiopaque anchor **600** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **600** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **600** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **600** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **600** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(65) The radiopaque anchor **600** extends from a proximal end **602** to a distal end **604**. The proximal end region **606**, adjacent to the proximal end **602**, may have a generally ellipsoid cross-sectional shape, or a rectangular shape with at least two opposing edges having curved surfaces. The proximal end region **606** may be flared such that a first end region **608** and a second end region **610** may have a larger radial dimension than an intermediate region **609** disposed therebetween. However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **606** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **612**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **606** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **614**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **606** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **614**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **606** may be laser cut to define the openings **614**. At least the proximal end region **606** of the radiopaque anchor **600** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **606** is self-

expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **606** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **606** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(66) The proximal end region **606** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **600** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **600** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **600**. A cylindrical elongate member **616** may extend distally from the distal end **618** of the proximal end region **606** to the distal end **604** of the radiopaque anchor **600**. In some cases, the elongate member **616** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **616** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filled with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **604** of the radiopaque anchor **600** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **600** into the tissue. It is further contemplated that the cross-sectional dimension may vary along the length of the elongate member **616** to facilitate deployment. For example, a distal end region **622** may have a smaller cross-sectional dimension than a proximal end region **620** of the elongate member **616**. This is just one example.

(67) The radiopaque anchor **600**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **600** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(68) FIG. **13** is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **650**. The radiopaque anchor **650** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **650** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **650** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **650** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **650** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(69) The radiopaque anchor **650** extends from a proximal end **652** to a distal end **654**. The proximal end region **656**, adjacent to the proximal end **652**, may have a first end region **658** and a second end region **660**. The first end region **658** may have a three-dimensional tear drop shape that tapers or decreases in cross-sectional dimension in the proximal direction (e.g., towards the proximal end **652**). The second end region **660** may have a three-dimensional tear drop shape that tapers or decreases in cross-sectional dimension in the distal direction (e.g., towards the distal end **654**). However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **656** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **662**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **656** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **664**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **656** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **664**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **656** may be laser cut to define the openings **664**. At least the proximal end region **656** of the radiopaque anchor **650** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **656** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **656** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **656** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(70) The proximal end region **656** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the

radiopaque anchor **650** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **650** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **650**. A cylindrical elongate member **668** may extend distally from the distal end **670** of the proximal end region **656** to the distal end **654** of the radiopaque anchor **650**. In some cases, the elongate member **668** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **668** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filed with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **654** of the radiopaque anchor **650** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **650** into the tissue. It is further contemplated that the cross-sectional dimension may vary along the length of the elongate member **668** to facilitate deployment.

(71) The radiopaque anchor **650**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **650** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(72) FIG. **14** is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **700**. The radiopaque anchor **700** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **700** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **700** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **700** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **700** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(73) The radiopaque anchor **700** extends from a proximal end **702** to a distal end **704**. The proximal end region **706**, adjacent to the proximal end **702**, may have a generally cylindrical shape having a generally uniform cross-sectional dimension along a length thereof. However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **706** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **710**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **706** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **712**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **706** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **712**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **706** may be laser cut to define the openings **712**. At least the proximal end region **706** of the radiopaque anchor **700** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **706** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **706** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **706** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(74) The proximal end region **706** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **700** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **700** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **700**. A cylindrical elongate member **716** may extend distally from the distal end **718** of the proximal end region **706** to the distal end **704** of the radiopaque anchor **700**. In some cases, the elongate member **716** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **716** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filed with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **704** of the radiopaque anchor **700** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **700** into the tissue. It is further contemplated that the cross-sectional dimension may vary along the length

of the elongate member **716** to facilitate deployment.

(75) The radiopaque anchor **700**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **700** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(76) FIG. **15** is a perspective view of another illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **750**. The radiopaque anchor **750** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **750** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **750** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **750** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **750** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(77) The radiopaque anchor **750** extends from a proximal end **752** to a distal end **754**. The proximal end region **756**, adjacent to the proximal end **752**, may have a generally flattened spheroid shape. However, other shapes may be used as desired. The proximal end region **756** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **758**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **756** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **760**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **756** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **760**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **756** may be laser cut to define the openings **760**. At least the proximal end region **756** of the radiopaque anchor **750** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **756** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **756** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **756** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(78) The proximal end region **756** may be configured to provide a surface for actuating the radiopaque anchor **750** through a lumen during deployment, limit penetration of the radiopaque anchor **750** into the tissue, and/or seal the puncture in the tissue caused by deployment of the radiopaque anchor **750**. A cylindrical elongate member **762** may extend distally from the distal end **764** of the proximal end region **756** to the distal end **754** of the radiopaque anchor **750**. In some cases, the elongate member **762** may be a generally solid component. In other cases, the elongate member **762** may be a hollow component defining a central cavity therein (not explicitly shown) which may be filled with a radiopaque material. In some embodiments, the distal end **754** of the radiopaque anchor **750** may be pointed to facilitate deployment of the radiopaque anchor **750** into the tissue. It is further contemplated that the cross-sectional dimension may vary along the length of the elongate member **762** to facilitate deployment.

(79) The radiopaque anchor **750**, or components thereof, may be formed from, coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **750** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(80) FIG. **16** is a perspective view of another illustrative proximal end region **800** of a radiopaque anchor that may be used in addition to or in place of any of the structures described herein. The proximal end region **800** may have a generally equal length **802** and width **804**. The edges **806a**,

806b, **806c**, **806d** (collectively, **806**) of the proximal end region **800** may be curved to form rounded corners **808a**, **808b**, **808c**, **808d** (collectively, **808**) and radially inward extending valleys **810a**, **810b**, **810c**, **810d** (collectively, **810**). The proximal end region **800** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **812**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **800** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **814**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **800** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **814**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **800** may be laser cut to define the openings **814**. At least the proximal end region **800** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **800** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **800** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **800** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(81) FIG. **17** is a perspective view of another illustrative proximal end region **850** of a radiopaque anchor that may be used in addition to or in place of any of the structures described herein. The proximal end region **850** may have a length **852** that is greater than a width **854** thereof. The reverse configuration is also contemplated. The edges **856a**, **856b**, **856c**, **856d** (collectively, **856**) of the proximal end region **850** may be curved to form rounded corners **858a**, **858b**, **858c**, **858d** (collectively, **858**) and radially inward extending valleys **860a**, **860b**, **860c**, **860d** (collectively, **860**). The proximal end region **850** may have a woven structure fabricated from a number of filaments or struts **862**. In some embodiments, the proximal end region **850** may be knitted or braided with a single filament or strut interwoven with itself and defining open cells **864**. In other embodiments, the proximal end region **850** may be braided with several filaments or struts interwoven together and defining open cells **864**. In yet other embodiments, the proximal end region **850** may be laser cut to define the openings **864**. At least the proximal end region **850** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol, so that the proximal end region **850** is self-expanding upon deployment. During navigation to the deployment location, the proximal end region **850** may be radially compressed to a lower profile delivery configuration. It is contemplated that the proximal end region **850** may be formed from other expandable structures, as desired.

(82) FIG. **18** is a perspective view of an illustrative implantable radiopaque marker or anchor **900**. The radiopaque anchor **900** is configured to be implanted in the nadir (hinge point) of the non-coronary, right coronary, and/or left-coronary cusps to serve as markers for identification of the proper plane for valve deployment. However, the radiopaque anchor **900** may be used in other anatomical locations for different procedures, as desired. The radiopaque anchor **900** may have dimensions in the range of about 0.5 millimeters (mm) to about 2.0 mm, about 0.75 mm to about 1.75 mm, or about 1.0 to about 1.5 mm. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **900** may have dimensions of less than 0.5 mm or greater than 2.0 mm, as desired. It is contemplated that the size of the radiopaque anchor **900** may be determined based on the anatomical location it will be implanted.

(83) The radiopaque anchor **900** includes a generally helical body **906** extending from a proximal end region **902** to a distal end region **904**. The distal end region **904** may include a pointed distal end **908**, although this is not required. It is contemplated that the radiopaque anchor **900** may be deployed into the target region such that it is “screwed” into the tissue. For example, the radiopaque anchor **900** may be rotated as it exits the lumen of the delivery catheter to secure the radiopaque anchor **900** within the tissue. When so provided, a pointed distal end **908** may puncture the tissue to facilitate distal advancement of the radiopaque anchor within the tissue.

(84) The radiopaque anchor **900** may be formed from a shape memory or superelastic material, such as, but not limited to, nitinol. However, this is not required. The radiopaque anchor **900** may be coated with, doped with, alloyed with, or otherwise include radiopaque materials, such as, but

not limited to, iodine, barium sulfate, iridium, platinum, tantalum, gold, palladium, tungsten, tin, silver, titanium, nickel, zirconium, rhenium, bismuth, molybdenum, combinations thereof, and the like). These are just some examples of how the radiopaque anchor **900** may be made radiopaque. Other materials and/or techniques may be used as desired.

(85) The radiopaque anchor **900** may be formed such that the body **906** forms a helix when the radiopaque anchor **900** is in the “remembered” or preformed shape. A biasing force (such as a deployment tube) may bias the body **906** such that it has a reduced profile relative to the preformed or deployed shape. For example, the biasing force may reduce the diameter of the helical body **906** while increasing a length thereof. Once the biasing force is removed the helical body **906** returns to its expanded configuration. However, in some cases, the radiopaque anchor **900** may be delivered to the deployment location in the expanded configuration.

(86) The radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be delivered using similar methods. The radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be loaded into a delivery device using known techniques. To deploy the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** within the body, the delivery device may be advanced through an outer sheath introduced into the right femoral artery, although other access points may be used as desired. The delivery device may be advanced through the outer sheath to the desired treatment location. In the case of a TAVR procedure, the delivery device may be advanced into the ascending aorta or adjacent to the aortic valve. Once the delivery device is in position, a radiopaque fluid and/or contrast agent may be delivered to the anatomy adjacent to the distal end region through a lumen of the delivery device. The radiopaque fluid and/or contrast agent may be used to identify the cusps of valve and one or more implant locations for at least one radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750**. The delivery device may then be oriented such that a distal opening of a delivery lumen is aligned with the desired implant location. The radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be loaded into the delivery lumen of the delivery system using known techniques

(87) Once the delivery device is in position a guidewire or other penetrating member may be advanced from the distal end of the delivery device so that it penetrates the target tissue (e.g., the left coronary cusp, right coronary cusp, and/or non-coronary cusp in the case of TAVR) to form a hole or channel. In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be deployed directly into the tissue without the formation of a hole or channel. After formation of the hole or channel, the guidewire may be removed from the delivery device. However, in some cases, such as, but not limited to, when the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** includes a lumen extending therethrough, the guidewire may be left in the delivery device and/or in the tissue during deployment of the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750**.

(88) A push member may then be used to distally advance the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** into the tissue. The radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may include features, such as barbs, hooks, enlarged end regions, etc. that preclude or limits dislodgement (e.g., proximal movement) of the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750**. Once the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** is anchored within the tissue, the push member and/or delivery device can be proximally retracted. In some cases, the guidewire, push member and/or delivery device may be fully removed from body. In other cases, the guidewire, push member and/or delivery device may be proximally retracted but remain in the body (e.g., displaced from the area of valve implantation).

(89) In some cases, the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be implanted within the tissue such that the proximal end thereof is fully within the tissue. In other embodiments, the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be implanted within the tissue such that the proximal end thereof is flush with or about at the surface of the tissue. In yet other embodiments, the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650,**

700, 750, 900 may be implanted within the tissue such that the proximal end thereof extends from the surface of the tissue. Once the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** has been delivered, the delivery device may be used to deliver one or more additional radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** to one or more additionally locations. For example, one or more radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be delivered to each cusp to improve visualization of the anatomy under fluoroscopy. In other cases, a radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may be positioned in each cusp. It is further contemplated that more than one dual lumen pigtail catheter may be used to deploy radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** in each cusp simultaneously or substantially simultaneously.

(90) It is contemplated that the implantation of one or more radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may reduce contrast injections within the patient. For example, once the radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** are positioned, the radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** are able to provide beacons for positioning of the TAVR valve. Further, as the pigtail catheter is not necessary for contrast injections after implantation of the radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900**, the pigtail catheter (or other delivery system) can be removed from the anatomy which may help facilitate delivery of the TAVR valve (e.g., fewer devices are in the vasculature during delivery of the TAVR valve). Additionally, the radiopaque anchors **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** may enable better visualization of the annulus plane during implantation of the valve while clearly identifying the orientation of the radiopaque anchor **300, 400, 450, 500, 550, 600, 650, 700, 750, 900** relative to the annular plane of the valve.

(91) Additionally, or alternatively, to the implantation of one or more radiopaque anchors, it may be desirable to control the depth of the implant. While transesophageal echocardiography may be used to facilitate visualization, it may be considered invasive and/or lack three-dimensional imaging capabilities. In some cases, aortography may be used; however, this may provide two-dimensional, partial reference-based imaging which relies on the ability of the contrast to fill the base of the native coronary cusps. Contrast aortography of a coaxial projection of the valve prosthesis may not show the representative depth relative to the native annulus. It may be desirable to provide a system and method for better controlling TAVR implant depth.

(92) FIG. 19 is perspective view of an illustrative system **1000** for measuring and guiding implant depth during a TAVR procedure. Generally, the system **1000** may include a pigtail catheter **1002** and an implant-depth wire **1004**. While the system **1000** is described as utilizing a pigtail catheter **1002**, other catheters, sheaths, etc. may be used, as desired. The pigtail catheter **1002** may be similar in form and function to the pigtail catheter **204** described herein. It is contemplated that other pigtail catheter **1002** configurations, such as, but not limited to the pigtail catheter **104** described herein, may also be used.

(93) The pigtail catheter **1002** includes a tubular elongate shaft **1006** extending from a proximal end configured to remain outside the body to the distal end region **1012**. The elongate shaft **1006** includes at least a first lumen **1008** configured to deliver a radiopaque fluid and/or a contrast fluid and a second lumen **1010** configured to deliver an implantable radiopaque marker. In some cases, the first lumen **1008** may have a diameter in the range of about 3 to about 5 French to allow for contrast injection and/or pressure measure. The second lumen **101** may have a diameter in the range of about 1 to about 3 French to slidably receive the implant-depth wire **1004**. The two or more lumens **1008, 1010** may be arranged in a side by side or collinear arrangement, in a coaxial or tube within a tube arrangement, or combinations thereof. The two or more lumens **1008, 1010** may be fluidly isolated from another

(94) The elongate shaft **1006** may include a first portion **1014** defining the first lumen **1008** and a second portion **1016** defining the second lumen **1010**. It is contemplated that the first and second portions **1014, 1016** need not have the same length as each other. In some embodiments, the

elongate shaft **1006** may be extruded as a single monolithic structure to form side-by-side lumens **1008**, **1010**. In other embodiments, the elongate shaft **1006** may be formed by other suitable means, such as a first and a second separate extruded tubes arranged side-by-side and connected by adhesive, or the like.

(95) The first lumen **1008** may extend from the proximal end of the first portion **1014** towards a distal end **1018** thereof. In some cases, the first lumen **1008** may terminate proximal to the distal end **1018** of the first portion **1014** while in other cases, the first lumen **1008** may extend to the distal end **1018** to define a distal opening **1020**. The second lumen **1010** may extend from the proximal end of the second portion **1016** towards a distal end **1024** thereof. The second lumen **1010** may extend to the distal end **1024** to define a distal opening **1022** (e.g., distally facing). However, this is not required. In some cases, the second lumen **1010** may terminate proximal to the distal end **1024**. In such an instance, a side port may be provided to allow an implant-depth wire **1004** to be advanced through and exit the second lumen **1010**.

(96) In the absence of an external biasing force, or in a deployed configuration, the distal end region **1012** is configured to assume a curved pigtail or J shape. It is contemplated that the distal end region **1012** may have any degree of curvature desired including less than 360° or greater than 360°, as desired. The distal end region **1012** may be biased into a generally linear, or delivery, configuration by, for example, a guidewire or stiffening member slidably disposed within the lumen **1008** or a stiffer tube (such as, but not limited to an outer sheath) disposed over an outer surface of the pigtail catheter **1002**. These are just examples and are not intended to limit the pigtail catheter **1002** to a particular configuration.

(97) The first portion **1014** includes a set of holes or apertures **1026a**, **1026b**, **1026c**, **1026d**, **1026e**, **1026f** (collectively, **1026**). The set of apertures **1026** may include one, two, three, four, or more apertures, as desired. The set of apertures **1026** may be in fluid communication with a radiopaque fluid source and/or a contrast fluid source. As described herein, the second portion **1016** may include a distal opening **1022** through which an implant-depth wire **1004** is deployable. For example, the implant-depth wire **1004** may be pushed out of the distal opening **1022** and into the nadir of a cusp of the aortic valve, as will be described in more detail herein. In some cases, the distal end **1024** of the second portion **1016** may extend slightly around the curve of the pigtail portion such that the distal opening **1022** is configured to direct the implant-depth wire **1004** orthogonal to the tissue at the center of the cusp, although this is not required.

(98) In some cases, the set of apertures **1026** may be positioned on the first portion **1014** such that when the distal end region **1012** of the pigtail catheter **1002** is in the deployed configuration, the set of apertures **1026** are positioned or directed radially inwards relative to the curve of the distal end region **1012** (or on the concave surface thereof). However, this is not required. In some cases, the first set of apertures **1026** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **1006** such that when the distal end region **1012** of the pigtail catheter **1002** is in the deployed configuration the first set of apertures **1026** are positioned or directed radially outwards (not explicitly shown) relative to the curve of the distal end region **1012** (or on the convex surface thereof). It is contemplated that the position of the set of apertures **1026** is not limited to the radially inward or outward surface of the distal end region **1012**. It is contemplated that the set of apertures **1026** may be positioned at any circumferential location about the portion **1014**, or combinations of circumferential locations, as desired.

(99) The implant-depth wire **1004** may be an elongate wire or other elongate structure having a cross-section sized to slide within the second lumen **1010** of the pigtail catheter **1004**. In some cases, the implant-depth wire **1004** may have a generally solid cross-section while in other cases, the implant-depth wire **1004** may be generally tubular. The implant-depth wire **1004** may include a plurality of radiopaque markers **1028a**, **1028b**, **1028c**, **1028d**, **1028e**, **1028f** (collectively, **1028**) spaced along a length thereof. In some cases, a first radiopaque marker **1028a** may be positioned at a distal end **1030** of the implant-depth wire **1004**. The implant-depth wire **1004** may include any

number of radiopaque markers **1028** desired, such as, but not limited to, one, two, three, four, five, six, or more. The radiopaque markers **1028** may be evenly or uniformly spaced along a distal end region of the implant-depth wire **1004**. For example, the radiopaque markers **1028** may be spaced in the range of 1 to 10 millimeters, in the range of 2 to 8 millimeters, or about 5 millimeters from one another. In some cases, the radiopaque markers **1028** may extend proximally along at least a portion of a length of the implant-depth wire **1004** such that the radiopaque markers **1028** may be used to help verify coronary artery heights during the procedure. It is contemplated that radiopaque markers **1032a**, **1032b**, **1032c**, **1032d** may also be provided on the pigtail catheter **1002** which may be used to help verify coronary artery heights during the procedure. The radiopaque markers **1032** may be similar in form and function to the radiopaque markers **1028**.

(100) Radiopaque materials are understood to be materials capable of producing a relatively bright image on a fluoroscopy screen or another imaging technique during a medical procedure. This relatively bright image aids the user of the system **1000** in determining its location. Some examples of radiopaque materials can include, but are not limited to, gold, platinum, palladium, tantalum, tungsten alloy, polymer material loaded with a radiopaque filler, and the like.

(101) The radiopaque markers **1028** may be incorporated in the implant-depth wire **1004** in a number of different manners. For example, the material of the implant-depth wire **1004** may be doped with a radiopaque material at predefined intervals to provide radiopaque regions. In other cases, radiopaque material may be embedded into a thickness of the implant-depth wire **1004**. In yet another example, radiopaque cuffs may be positioned over an outer surface of the implant-depth wire **1004** and attached thereto. It is further contemplated that the entire implant-depth wire **1004** may be formed from a radiopaque material. In such an instance, material may be removed from the implant-depth wire **1004** to form regions having a reduced cross-sectional dimension at predefined intervals. The region having the smaller cross-sectional dimension may function as the distance identifiers.

(102) It is contemplated that the implant-depth wire **1004** may be provided with features configured to facilitate advancement of the implant-depth wire **1004** into bodily tissue. In some cases, the distal end **1030** of the implant-depth wire **1004** may be pointed or include a needle-tip to penetrate the tissue. In one example, the implant-depth wire **1004** may include a telescoping needle such that the needle can retract once the tissue has been penetrated. Alternatively, or additionally, the distal end **1030** of the implant-depth wire **1004** may include an electrode such that radiofrequency (RF) energy may be delivered to facilitate penetration of the tissue. In such an instance, a length of the implant-depth wire **1004** may be insulated so as to limit the RF energy delivery to the distal end **1030**.

(103) Referring now to FIG. **20**, which illustrates the system **1000** for measuring and guiding implant depth during a TAVR procedure in use, the pigtail catheter **1002** is first positioned in the non-coronary cusp (NCC) **1040** of the aortic valve **1050**. In other cases, the pigtail catheter **1002** may be positioned in the right coronary cusp (RCC) **1042** or the left coronary cusp (LCC) **1044**. The implant-depth wire **1004** may then be distally advanced from the distal opening **1022** of the second portion **1016** of the pigtail catheter **1002**. The implant-depth wire **1004** may penetrate the nadir of the NCC **1040**. The distal end region **1012** of the pigtail catheter **1002** and/or the distal end region of the implant-depth wire **1004** may include retention features, such as, but not limited to barbs, spikes, etc. configured to temporarily secure the system **1000** to the body tissue. The implant (e.g., TAVR valve) may then be delivered using the radiopaque markers **1028** as a guide. The implant-depth wire **1004** may provide a simple and intuitive system to help guide the depth of the implant of any valve system without requiring a change to clinical workflow of a valve replacement procedure. Once the implant is positioned and deployed, the implant-depth wire **1004** and the pigtail catheter **1002** may be removed.

(104) To facilitate delivery of the pigtail catheter **1002** and/or the implant-depth wire **1004**, a proximal end region of the system **1000** may be provided with a locking mechanism to secure the

implant-depth wire **1004** relative to the pigtail catheter. For example, the locking mechanism may secure the implant-depth wire **1004** relative to the pigtail catheter **1002** such that the implant-depth wire **1004** remains within the second lumen **1010** during advancement of the pigtail catheter **1002** while the system **1000** is being advanced through the vasculature. It is further contemplated that the locking mechanism may be used to secure the implant-depth wire **1004** relative to the pigtail catheter **1002** after the implant-depth wire **1004** has been advanced into the body tissue. Some illustrative locking mechanisms may include, but are not limited to, friction fits, tongue and groove fits, or other mechanical interfaces, as desired. Some illustrative locking mechanisms are described in commonly assigned U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/031,070, titled WEDGE-LOCK SHEATH RETENTION MECHANISM, Ser. No. 16,811,296, titled, PINCH-LOCK SHEATH RETENTION MECHANISM, and Ser. No. 16/280,104, titled MEDICAL DEVICE RELEASE SYSTEM, the disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

(105) FIG. **21** is side view of an illustrative pigtail catheter **1100** for deploying an implant-depth wire **1004** or delivering a radiopaque implant such as those described herein. The pigtail catheter **1100** includes a tubular elongate shaft **1102** extending from a proximal end configured to remain outside the body to the distal end region **1108**. The elongate shaft **1102** includes at least a first lumen **1104** configured to deliver a radiopaque fluid and/or a contrast fluid and a second lumen **1106** configured to deliver an implantable radiopaque marker. In some cases, the first lumen **1104** may have a diameter in the range of about 3 to about 5 French to allow for contrast injection and/or pressure measure. The second lumen **101** may have a diameter in the range of about 1 to about 3 French to slidably receive the implant-depth wire **1004** (or radiopaque implant). The two or more lumens **1104**, **1106** may be arranged in a side by side or collinear arrangement, in a coaxial or tube within a tube arrangement, or combinations thereof. The two or more lumens **1104**, **1106** may be fluidly isolated from another

(106) The elongate shaft **1102** may include a first portion **1110** defining the first lumen **1104** and a second portion **1112** defining the second lumen **1106**. It is contemplated that the first and second portions **1110**, **1112** need not have the same length as each other. In some embodiments, the elongate shaft **1102** may be extruded as a single monolithic structure to form side-by-side lumens **1104**, **1106**. In other embodiments, the elongate shaft **1102** may be formed by other suitable means, such as a first and a second separate extruded tubes arranged side-by-side and connected by adhesive, or the like.

(107) The first lumen **1104** may extend from the proximal end of the first portion **1110** towards a distal end **1116** thereof. In some cases, the first lumen **1104** may terminate proximal to the distal end **1116** of the first portion **1110** while in other cases, the first lumen **1104** may extend to the distal end **1116** to define a distal opening **1114**. The second lumen **1106** may extend from the proximal end of the second portion **1112** towards a distal end **1118** thereof. The second lumen **1106** may extend to the distal end **1118** to define a distal opening **1120** (e.g., distally facing). However, this is not required. In some cases, the second lumen **1106** may terminate proximal to the distal end **1118**. In such an instance, a side port may be provided to allow an implant-depth wire **1004** to be advanced through and exit the second lumen **1106**.

(108) In the absence of an external biasing force, or in a deployed configuration, the distal end region **1108** is configured to assume a curved pigtail or J shape. It is contemplated that the distal end region **1108** may have any degree of curvature desired including less than 360° or greater than 360°, as desired. For example, the distal end region **1108** may be custom-formed to an individual patient's anatomy based on pre-operative imaging. Alternatively, the clinician may select from a variety of catheter shapes to fit (as closely as possible) the patient's non-coronary cusp anatomy. The pigtail catheter **1100** illustrated in FIG. **21** is just one illustrative example of how the curved distal end region **1108** may vary for a patient's anatomy. The distal end region **1108** may be biased into a generally linear, or delivery, configuration by, for example, a guidewire or stiffening member slidably disposed within the lumen **1104** or a stiffer tube (such as, but not limited to an outer

sheath) disposed over an outer surface of the pigtail catheter **1100**. These are just examples and are not intended to limit the pigtail catheter **1100** to a particular configuration.

(109) The first portion **1110** includes a set of holes or apertures **1122a**, **1122b**, **1122c**, **1122d**, **1122e** (collectively, **1122**). The set of apertures **1122** may include one, two, three, four, or more apertures, as desired. The set of apertures **1122** may be in fluid communication with a radiopaque fluid source and/or a contrast fluid source. As described herein, the second portion **1112** may include a distal opening **1120** through which an implant-depth wire **1004** is deployable. For example, the implant-depth wire **1004** may be pushed out of the distal opening **1120** and into the nadir of a cusp of the aortic valve, as will be described in more detail herein. In some cases, the distal end **1118** of the second portion **1112** may extend slightly around the curve of the pigtail portion such that the distal opening **1120** is configured to direct the implant-depth wire **1004** orthogonal to the tissue at the center of the cusp, although this is not required.

(110) In some cases, the set of apertures **1122** may be positioned on the first portion **1110** such that when the distal end region **1108** of the pigtail catheter **1100** is in the deployed configuration, the set of apertures **1122** are positioned or directed radially inwards relative to the curve of the distal end region **1108** (or on the concave surface thereof). However, this is not required. In some cases, the first set of apertures **1122** may be positioned on the elongate shaft **1102** such that when the distal end region **1108** of the pigtail catheter **1100** is in the deployed configuration the first set of apertures **1122** are positioned or directed radially outwards (not explicitly shown) relative to the curve of the distal end region **1108** (or on the convex surface thereof). It is contemplated that the position of the set of apertures **1122** is not limited to the radially inward or outward surface of the distal end region **1108**. It is contemplated that the set of apertures **1122** may be positioned at any circumferential location about the portion **1110**, or combinations of circumferential locations, as desired.

(111) As used herein, the relative terms “proximal” and “distal” shall be defined from the perspective of the delivery system. Thus, proximal refers to the direction of the handle portion of the delivery system and distal refers to the direction of the distal tip.

(112) Conditional language used herein, such as, among others, “can,” “might,” “may,” “e.g.,” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that some embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements, and/or states. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements, blocks, and/or states are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without author input or prompting, whether these features, elements and/or states are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment.

(113) Although certain embodiments and examples have been described herein, it may be understood by those skilled in the art that many aspects of the delivery systems shown and described in the present disclosure may be differently combined and/or modified to form still further embodiments or acceptable examples. All such modifications and variations are intended to be included herein within the scope of this disclosure. A wide variety of designs and approaches are possible. No feature, structure, or step disclosed herein is essential or indispensable.

(114) For purposes of this disclosure, certain aspects, advantages, and novel features are described herein. It is to be understood that not necessarily all such advantages may be achieved in accordance with any particular embodiment. Thus, for example, those skilled in the art may recognize that the disclosure may be embodied or carried out in a manner that achieves one advantage or a group of advantages as taught herein without necessarily achieving other advantages as may be taught or suggested herein.

(115) Moreover, while illustrative embodiments have been described herein, the scope of any and all embodiments having equivalent elements, modifications, omissions, combinations (e.g., of aspects across various embodiments), adaptations and/or alterations as would be appreciated by

those in the art based on the present disclosure. The limitations in the claims are to be interpreted broadly based on the language employed in the claims and not limited to the examples described in the present specification or during the prosecution of the application, which examples are to be construed as non-exclusive. Further, the actions of the disclosed processes and methods may be modified in any manner, including by reordering actions and/or inserting additional actions and/or deleting actions. It is intended, therefore, that the specification and examples be considered as illustrative only, with a true scope and spirit being indicated by the claims and their full scope of equivalents.

(116) While the methods and devices described herein may be susceptible to various modifications and alternative forms, specific examples thereof have been shown in the drawings and are described in detail herein. It should be understood, however, that the inventive subject matter is not to be limited to the particular forms or methods disclosed, but, to the contrary, covers all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the spirit and scope of the various implementations described and the appended claims. Further, the disclosure herein of any particular feature, aspect, method, property, characteristic, quality, attribute, element, or the like in connection with an implementation or embodiment can be used in all other implementations or embodiments set forth herein. In any methods disclosed herein, the acts or operations can be performed in any suitable sequence and are not necessarily limited to any particular disclosed sequence and not be performed in the order recited. Various operations can be described as multiple discrete operations in turn, in a manner that can be helpful in understanding certain embodiments; however, the order of description should not be construed to imply that these operations are order dependent. Additionally, the structures described herein can be embodied as integrated components or as separate components. For purposes of comparing various embodiments, certain aspects and advantages of these embodiments are described. Not necessarily all such aspects or advantages are achieved by any particular embodiment. Thus, for example, embodiments can be carried out in a manner that achieves or optimizes one advantage or group of advantages without necessarily achieving other advantages or groups of advantages. The methods disclosed herein may include certain actions taken by a practitioner; however, the methods can also include any third-party instruction of those actions, either expressly or by implication. The ranges disclosed herein also encompass any and all overlap, sub-ranges, and combinations thereof. Language such as “up to,” “at least,” “greater than,” “less than,” “between,” and the like includes the number recited. Numbers preceded by a term such as “about” or “approximately” include the recited numbers and should be interpreted based on the circumstances (e.g., as accurate as reasonably possible under the circumstances, for example $\pm 5\%$, $\pm 10\%$, $\pm 15\%$, etc.). For example, “about 7 mm” includes “7 mm.” Phrases preceded by a term such as “substantially” include the recited phrase and should be interpreted based on the circumstances (e.g., as much as reasonably possible under the circumstances). For to example, “substantially straight” includes “straight.”

(117) Those skilled in the art will recognize that the present invention may be manifested in a variety of forms other than the specific embodiments described and contemplated herein. Accordingly, departure in form and detail may be made without departing from the scope and spirit of the present invention as described in the appended claims.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: a pigtail catheter, the pigtail catheter comprising: an elongate shaft extending from a proximal end to a distal end, the elongate shaft defining: a first lumen extending distally from a proximal end, the first lumen in fluid communication with one or more apertures extending through a side wall of the elongate shaft; and a second lumen extending distally from a proximal end, the second lumen in fluid communication with at least one opening in the elongate shaft, wherein the at least one opening in the elongate shaft is distally facing; and an implantable

- radiopaque anchor configured to be permanently implanted within tissue, the implantable radiopaque anchor slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor includes a single linear tubular body having a distal end region and a proximal end region and a plurality of barbs extending radially outward and proximally from the distal end region, such that the plurality of barbs precludes dislodgement of the implantable radiopaque anchor proximally from the tissue.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one opening in the elongate shaft extends through the side wall of the elongate shaft.
 3. The system of claim 1, wherein the proximal end region of the implantable radiopaque anchor comprises a plurality of barbs, wherein the plurality of barbs of both the distal end region and the proximal end region includes one or more tines.
 4. The system of claim 3, wherein the one or more curved tines in the proximal end region are movable between an expanded deployed configuration and a compressed delivery configuration.
 5. The system of claim 1, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor comprises a biodegradable polymer doped with or carrying a radiopaque material.
 6. The system of claim 1, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor is at least partially formed from a shape memory material.
 7. A system for guiding implant depth, the system comprising: a pigtail catheter, the pigtail catheter comprising: an elongate shaft extending from a proximal end to a distal end, the elongate shaft defining: a first lumen extending distally from a proximal end to the distal end of the elongate shaft, the first lumen in fluid communication with one or more apertures extending through a side wall of the elongate shaft, wherein the one or more apertures are disposed along a distal region of the pigtail catheter configured to form a curving region when deployed; and a second lumen extending distally from a proximal end to a distal end positioned proximal of the one or more apertures extending through the side wall of the elongate shaft, the distal end of the second lumen defining a distally facing opening; wherein the first lumen and the second lumen are disposed side-by-side; and implantable radiopaque anchor configured to be permanently implanted within tissue, the implantable radiopaque anchor slidably disposed within the second lumen of the elongate shaft.
 8. A method for deploying an implantable radiopaque anchor, the method comprising: advancing the pigtail catheter of claim 1 through the vasculature to a target location; identifying an implant location; advancing a penetrating member through the pigtail catheter to form a channel in a tissue at the implant location and then removing the penetrating member from the pigtail catheter; and inserting an implantable radiopaque anchor within the channel, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor includes a tubular body and a plurality of barbs extending radially outward and proximally from only a distal end region of the tubular body, such that the plurality of barbs precludes dislodgement of the implantable radiopaque anchor proximally from the tissue.
 9. The method of claim 8, wherein identifying the implant location includes administering a radiopaque fluid or contrast agent adjacent to the target location.
 10. The method of claim 8, wherein inserting the implantable radiopaque anchor within the channel comprises actuating the implantable radiopaque anchor through the second lumen of the pigtail catheter and out the at least one distally facing opening in the side wall of the pigtail catheter.
 11. The system of claim 1, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor has a lumen extending longitudinally through the single linear tubular body.
 12. The method of claim 10, wherein the implantable radiopaque anchor has a lumen extending longitudinally through the tubular body, and wherein distally actuating the implantable radiopaque anchor through the second lumen of the pigtail catheter includes sliding the implantable radiopaque anchor over a guidewire disposed within the second lumen.
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